Preface

Change is the law, growth is optional: choose wisely.

I had read this adage long ago and never forgot it. I have consciously practised the message inherent in it.

Life continues to surge ahead. My police service has paved the way for a large 'people role'. Now, post-retirement, I travel, write, conduct a radio programme, host a TV show, take up speaking engagements, raise support for worthy causes, oversee the growth of my non-profit organizations and do even more.

With Divine Grace, I am a master of my time, with options to be with myself or change gears to be with others. As of now, I have chosen to embark upon another journey at my own speed, in which I am seeking more growth – in order to make a difference, in causes, small or big.

I have learnt from *Vipassana* meditation that nothing is permanent. All I have is the present. The past is gone; the future is yet to come. I have to do the maximum here and now.

I therefore wish to thank all those who made my life a source of constant learning, including those who made it hard for me. For without them I would not have learnt to grow. I brook no negativity and seek forgiveness from anyone I may have offended.

I have updated this book. The objective is to document, firsthand, the history of the first woman officer of the Indian Police Service.

Because I will be history one day…

– Kiran Bedi